Geographies of Discontent

Public Service Deprivation and the Rise of the Far Right in Italy

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Codebook

This Version: October 23, 2024

Electoral Data

Source: Electoral data are sourced from the Italian Ministry of the Interior. Socioeconomic data are sourced from the Italian National Institute of Statistics (ISTAT).

Name: electoral_panel_dataset.dta

Description: This dataset contains municipal-level electoral and socioeconomic data since 2001.

Variables:

- date_election: date of election
- year: election year
- municipality: name of municipality
- id08: municipal ID in 2008, from 1 to 7,964, in alphabetical order
- cod_prov: province code
- province: province name

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- region: region name
- treated: coded 1 if municipality is treated
- post: coded 1 if year is greater than 2010
- t: coded 1 if both *treated* and *post* are 1
- t18: coded 1 if *treated* is 1 and *year* is 2018
- t13: coded 1 if *treated* is 1 and *year* is 2013
- t08: coded 1 if *treated* is 1 and *year* is 2008
- t06: coded 1 if *treated* is 1 and *year* is 2006
- t01: coded 1 if *treated* is 1 and *year* is 2001
- turnout: turnout level (percentage)
- fusion_id: unique identifier for municipal fusion
- fused_vote_share: share of votes for merged municipalities
- mont_group: coded 1 if municipality belongs to a mountain community
- pop_tot_2008: overall population in 2008
- foreign_share_2008: foreign population in 2008
- female_share_2008: female population in 2008
- male_share_2008: male population in 2008
- over65_share_2008: over-65 population in 2008
- share_university2001: share of college graduates in 2001
- share_university2011: share of college graduates in 2011
- mean_income2008: average income in 2008

- mean_income_bottom_bracket: mean income for the bottom bracket
- mean_income_top_bracket: mean income for the top bracket
- income_inequality2008: income inequality computed as mean_income_top_bracket − mean_income_bottom_bracket
- max_altitude: maximum municipal altitude
- mean_altitude: mean municipal altitude
- chall_sh: share of votes for challenger parties
- farright_sh: share of votes for far-right parties
- right_sh: share of votes for right-wing parties
- rightfarright_sh: share of votes for right and far-right parties
- farright_noANnoL_sh: share of votes for far-right parties without Alleanza Nazionale (AN) and Lega (L)
- farright_noAN_sh: share of votes for far-right parties without Alleanza Nazionale (AN)
- left_sh: share of votes for left-wing parties
- farleft_sh: share of votes for far-left parties
- leftfarleft_sh: share of votes for left-wing and far-left parties
- m5s_sh: share of votes for Five Star Movement (M5S)
- incumbent_nat_10_sh: share of votes for the 2010 national incumbent
- incumbent_reg_10_sh: share of votes for the 2010 regional incumbent
- lega_sh: share of votes for Lega
- farright_noL_sh: share of votes for far-right parties without Lega

- m5s_left_sh: share of votes for left-wing parties and Five Star Movement
- m5s_leftfarleft_sh: share of votes for left-wing, far-left parties and Five Star Movement
- farright_sh_withinbloc: far-right shares relative to the coalition votes
- farleft_sh_withinbloc: far-left shares relative to the coalition votes
- lega_sh_withinincumb: share of far-right parties within the incumbent bloc
- north: coded 1 if municipality is in a northern region

Map Data

Source: Spatial data are sourced from the Italian National Institute of Statistics (ISTAT).[1]

Name: map_2008.dta

Description: This dataset contains spatial data for Italian municipalities in 2008.

Variables:

- year: election year (2008)
- municipality: name of municipality
- id08: municipal ID in 2008, from 1 to 7,964, in alphabetical order
- treated: coded 1 if municipality is treated
- _ID: spatial-unit ID
- _CX: x-coordinate of area centroid
- _CY: y-coordinate of area centroid
- PRO_COM: ISTAT municipality identifier
- SHAPE_LEN: shape length
- SHAPE_AREA: shape area

[1] https://www.istat.it/notizia/confini-delle-unita-amministrative-a-fini-statistici-al-1-gennaio-2018-2/

Individual-Level Attitudinal Data

Source: Individual-level data are sourced from the Italian National Election Studies (ITANES).[2] Municipal-level socioeconomic data are sourced from the Italian National Institute of Statistics (ISTAT).

Name: individual_panel_dataset.dta

Description: This dataset contains individual-level data for Italian respondents, and municipal-level controls.

Variables:

- id: respondent's unique identifier
- w: wave number
- post_reform: coded 1 if wave took place after the reform
- municipality: name of municipality
- region: region name
- PRO_COM: ISTAT municipality identifier
- gender: gender of respondent
- age: age of respondent
- edu: education level (1 "No qualification", 2 "Primary", 3 "Lower secondary", 4 "Professional", 5 "Upper secondary", 6 "Tertiary")
- occupation: occupation of respondent (1 "Manager", 2 "Teacher", 3 "Employee", 4 "Construction worker", 5 "Entrepreneur", 6 "Self-employed", 7 "Cooperative member", 8 "Other contract", 9 "Employed - mis. prof.", 10 "On welfare", 11 "Retired", 12 "Student")
- st_trust_parties: standardized score for trust in political parties

[2] https://www.cattaneo.org/itanes-2/

- st_trust_eu: standardized score for trust in the European Parliament
- st_trust_parliament: standardized score for trust in the parliament
- st_left_right: standardized score for placement on the left-right scale
- pol_efficacy: score for political efficacy
- st_trust_president: standardized score for trust in the president of the republic
- st_trust_judiciary: standardized score for trust in the judiciary
- immig_identity: immigration concern scale - identity and culture
- immig_employment: immigration concern scale - employment
- treated: coded 1 if respondent's municipality was treated
- mont_group: coded 1 if respondent's municipality was part of a mountain community
- pop_tot_2008: municipal population in 2008
- foreign_share_2008: municipal foreign population in 2008
- female_share_2008: municipal female population in 2008
- over65_share_2008: municipal over65 population in 2008
- share_university2001: municipal graduate population in 2008
- mean_income2008: municipal average income in 2008
- max_altitude: municipal average altitude in 2008
- cod_reg: regional code
- COD_PROV: province code
- age_cat: categorical variable for age (1 "18-24", 2 "25-34", 3 "35-44", 4 "45-54", 5 "55-64", 6 "65+")

- female: gender of respondent
- imm_add: immigration concern additive scale

Public Service Data

Source: Municipal-level public service data are sourced from Open Civitas[3], which provides access to data collected by the Italian Ministry of Economy and Finance (MEF).

Name: service_dataset.dta

Description: This dataset contains information on public service delivery for Italian municipalities.

Variables:

- municipality: name of municipality
- id08: municipal ID in 2008, from 1 to 7,964, in alphabetical order
- cod_prov: province code
- treated: coded 1 if municipality is treated
- mont_group: coded 1 if municipality belongs to a mountain community
- pop_tot_2008: overall population in 2008
- foreign_share_2008: foreign population in 2008
- female_share_2008: female population in 2008
- over65_share_2008: over-65 population in 2008
- share_university2001: share of college graduates in 2001
- mean_income2008: average income in 2008
- max_altitude: maximum altitude

[3] https://www.opencivitas.it/it/open-data

- year: year
- pol_diff: local police delivery against standard demand
- reg_diff: public registry delivery against standard demand
- garb_diff_orig: garbage collection delivery against standard demand
- pol_cap: local police service capacity index
- reg_cap: public registry service capacity index
- garb_cap: garbage collection service capacity index
- mis_police: coded 1 if missing yearly observation for both local police delivery measures
- mis_pol: coded 1 if missing overall observations for both local police delivery measures
- mis_registry: coded 1 if missing yearly observation for both public registry delivery measures
- mis_reg: coded 1 if missing overall observations for both public registry delivery measures
- mis_garbage: coded 1 if missing yearly observation for both garbage collection delivery measures
- mis_garb: coded 1 if missing overall observations for both garbage collection delivery measures
- pop_seg: municipality population segments
- garb_diff: winsored garbage collection delivery against standard demand

Party Positioning Data

Source: Party policy positioning data are sourced from the 1999-2019 Chapel Hill Expert Survey (CHES).[4]

Name: ches_scores.dta

Description: This dataset contains information on Italian parties' policy positioning.

Variables:

- party: party name
- ches_id: unique identifier for CHES
- ches_year: CHES survey year
- party_id: party identifier
- year: election year
- ches_party: CHES party abbreviation
- ches_parfam: CHES party family
- ches_lrecon: CHES economic left-right scale
- ches_mig_policy: CHES immigration policy
- farright: coded 1 if party is far right
- m5s_leftfarleft: coded 1 if party is either left-wing, far-left or M5S
- y: year abbreviation
- id_year: party-year abbreviation

[4] https://www.chesdata.eu/2019-chapel-hill-expert-survey

Income Data

Source: Income data are sourced using the average pre-tax household income from municipal tax records released by the Italian Ministry for the Economy and Finance (MEF).

Name: income_change.dta

Description: This dataset contains information on income change (2007-2009) and levels for Italian municipalities.

Variables:

- municipality: municipality name
- income_ch0709: change in income between 2007 and 2009
- adj_terc_inc: adjusted income tertile for municipality